http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc.)

Newsletter − April 2009

16th April 2009

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The next major event is -

T'Walk 2009

Canterbury, weekend 2nd/3rd May, 24hrs

Enter now! Registrations close on the 22nd April (less than one week!). Visit the website at http://www.cutc.org.nz/twalk/ to sign up online today.

Join the 43rd Annual TWALK! On this Twenty-four hour Walk you will be dropped off in a mystery rural location for an orienteering-style event. You have 24 hours to visit as many control points as possible. Alternatively, after the first wee bit of walking, join the party at the Hash House!

Entry fee is $75 (student price $45) - includes buses and all the food you can eat.

Looking for a team or team members? Email twalk@cutc.org.nz and we'll try to hook you up.

Get the T-shirt - let people know you're tough enough for TWALK! $20 with your entry.

Other Rogaines coming up

Eco Challenge, Waitakere City, this Sunday

This Sunday, 19th April, the annual Eco Challenge is run in Waitakere City. Organised by Lactic Turkey Events, this is a 4 hour urban navigation challenge exploring the extensive track network joining the parks and other green spaces of Waitakere city. Participants may travel by bus or on foot. Information at http://www.lacticturkey.co.nz/ .

Wellington Metlink City Safari, Sunday 17th May

The City Safari is another urban rogaine in which you can use public transport (bus, train, cablecar, ferry) in addition to your legs. There are 6hr and 3hr options. Entries close 7th May. For more information see the event website http://www.citysafari.org.nz .

Wanaka Rogaine, Mt. Pisa Station, Saturday 23rd May

This will be another Ed Stevens and Terry Davis special and there will be 6 and 12hr options. Entries are now open. They close on 18th May. Consult the event website http://www.highlandevents.co.nz/rogaine for details, entry form and a picture of typical stunning landforms in the area. Mount Pisa Station is on the western side of Lake Dunstan.

Australian Championships, Sat/Sun 6th & 7th June

Kiwis are welcome to join in the Oz Champs to be held in Western Australia about 100km southeast of Perth. For online/credit-card entry and complete information see the event website, http://wa.rogaine.asn.au/ozchamps/. Entries close 27th May.

Marlborough Rogaine, Sunday 14th June

There will be the usual 6 and 3hr options in the 7th Marlborough rogaine organised by Marlborough Orienteering Club and to be held "on stunning iconic Marlborough hill country and farmland". Entries close 31st May. Contact is jo.graeme@xtra.co.nz

Heights of Winter, Saturday 4th July

Peninsular and Plains Orienteers (PAPO) is organising the popular Heights of Winter this year. Further information will be provided on the NZRA website http://www.rogaine.org.nz and/or the PAPO website http://www.papo.org.nz/ closer to the event.

Afterwork Series, Wellington

This series of afterwork 3hr events at intervals of 3 or 4 weeks in the Wellington area continues through to the 16th of July. About 60 people attended the lead-in navigation course run by Mike Sheridan. The course was made up of two 2hr indoor sessions followed by a 6hr practical session and proved to be a great success. In addition to the mid-week events there is a 6hr weekend Rogaine on 28th June. See the Maptalk calendar, http://www.maptalk.co.nz/events/default.cfm?t=Rogaine , for details of these Rogaines.

Recent Events

R&R Sport Taylors Mistake Rogaine Series, Christchurch, weekly from 1st April

The last event in the R & R Sport Taylors Mistake Series of 3hr afterwork rogaines was held last night. People found the three rogaines on the Port Hills above Christchurch, organised by Nora Audra and Ian Edmond, a lot of fun. The first event saw 180 keen rogainers enjoying a glorious evening in the region of the Bellbird. Since daylight saving was still in full swing only the last hour was in darkness.

By way of contrast the weather for the second event was atrocious with southerly squalls sweeping the competitors in the general area of Mt Pleasant. With daylight saving finished all but 30 minutes was in the dark. An innovation for this occasion was navigation via a Sudoku puzzle to a bonus checkpoint – much appreciated by those who solved it.

And for the final event, scrambling around the hills and cliffs at Taylors Mistake in the dark, the evening was calm and balmy again, and very pleasant for the barbeque and prize giving that completed the series. There were some top-line scores tonight and throughout the series.
For full results, commentary, and pictures visit: http://www.madeventz.co.nz/tmrogaine/.

Future Events

Remember to consult the NZRA website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz/ , and the Maptalk website http://www.maptalk.co.nz/events/default.cfm?t=Rogaine regularly for further events.

World Rogaining Champs Entry Criteria Discussion Paper

The IRF (International Rogaining Federation) has circulated a discussion document which proposes limiting entries in the World Champs. The document is available on the homepage of the NZRA website. Comments are invited from any interested persons but note that comments have to be in by May 1st.

The thrust of the document is that:

(1) The entry be limited to 500, or up to 600 on the discretion of the event organiser
(2) Team size is limited to 2 or 3 people.
(3) Privileged entries are allocated under three broad criteria:
  (a) Competitiveness.
    - previous world champions and some placegetters in the various categories
    - ERC (European Rogaining Championships), NARC (North American RC), and ARC (Australian RC) regional champions and some placegetters in the various categories
  (b) Participation and volunteerism
    - longstanding participants and organisers
  (c) Diversity
    - up to 5 teams from each country

When all the above entries have been allocated (first cut off date for registration), entry will be on a first come first served basis up to final cut off date for registration.

It is difficult to assess the impact of the privileged entries as it depends on the uptake of these privileges. Have a look at the document accessible from a link near the top of the homepage of the NZRA website http://www.rogaine.org.nz/ and if you wish to have a say then please email comments to our IRF representative Alan Holdaway (holdaway@xtra.co.nz.) and copy to NZRA secretary Grant Hunter (g.hunter@clear.net.nz).

Several on the NZRA committee have already offered comment to IRF on the pre-circulation draft and these will be resubmitted. Their comments (non-collated) are viewable on email request to Grant Hunter . Note that these proposed rules relate only to World Championship events.

Graphic and Web Design assistance

NZRA would appreciate some help with website design and with the design of publicity material for the World Championship event in November 2010. The first target is a brochure to take to the Australian Champs in June. If you have design skills and can help us we'd love to hear from you; email Grant Hunter (g.hunter@clear.net.nz).

Some thoughts on Night Navigation by Jamie Stewart

Jamie sent in a link to a few thoughts he has posted on night navigation. They don't pretend to be complete but are worth thinking about. See

http://osquad.blogspot.com/2009/04/thoughts-on-topo-navigation.html

If anyone has similar words of wisdom about navigation, or any other aspect of Rogaining, that would be useful to others then send them in to Bill at kennedyz@xtra.co.nz for publication.

We hope to see all you keen people at an event soon, particularly T'Walk.

Regards,
NZRA.